P. Developer Experience & Platform Governance

Standalone capability brief · Suggested module: **Internal Developer Platform**

Purpose

Help teams build, ship, and operate services using consistent golden paths while preserving room for justified exceptions and domain-specific design.

1. Scope and capability areas

Scaffolding

Provide maintained service templates, repository setup, and baseline CI/CD configuration.

Service catalog

Track service purpose, owner, lifecycle, dependencies, APIs, dashboards, and runbooks.

Architecture records

Capture architecture decision records and important trade-offs.

Golden paths

Offer reference implementations for common service types, deployment patterns, and integrations.

Local development

Provide reproducible local environments, test dependencies, fixtures, and seeded datasets.

Version and deprecation policy

Manage SDK compatibility, platform support windows, and migration workflows.

Operational readiness

Check ownership, alerts, runbooks, SLOs, security controls, and deployment provenance before production.

2. Shared contracts and standards

- Every production service has a named owner, catalog entry, support route, and operational documentation.
- Templates are versioned and maintained; generated services receive a documented upgrade path.
- Exceptions to golden paths are recorded with rationale, owner, and review date.
- Platform tooling reduces repeated work rather than becoming a mandatory bottleneck for every change.

3. Recommended implementation approach

- Create self-service templates that embed secure defaults, telemetry, health checks, and release metadata.
- Publish searchable service ownership and dependency information.
- Provide a paved path for local setup, test execution, deployment, and rollback.
- Measure developer friction and prioritize platform improvements based on observed bottlenecks.

- Automate readiness checks while allowing reviewed exceptions for legitimate needs.

4. Failure behavior and operational expectations

- If a template is deprecated, provide migration guidance and a supported transition period.
- Catalog data gaps should be visible and assigned rather than silently ignored.
- Platform tooling outages should have documented manual or alternate paths for critical delivery.

5. Suggested operational metrics

- Time to first successful deployment
- Time spent on environment setup
- Template adoption and upgrade lag
- Service catalog completeness
- Developer satisfaction and platform support load

6. Readiness and acceptance checklist

- [ ] A new service can be scaffolded with secure defaults quickly.
- [ ] Ownership, dependencies, runbooks, and telemetry are discoverable.
- [ ] Platform SDK and template versions have support policies.
- [ ] Golden-path exceptions are explicit and reviewable.

Ownership note: assign a named team, service owner, support route, versioning policy, and deprecation process before treating this capability as a platform contract.